

Annotation Guidelines

For each post by labor unions' accounts, consider the field text (i.e. post caption).

Consider what is **explicitly cued in the main text and in the hashtags**, without referring to additional or external knowledge. DO NOT consider information embedded in referenced links.

Because it is too subjective and impossible to fully determine if somebody is joking or being sarcastic, treat all messages at face value.

Discourse Frames

Treat each task within this annotation group as separate. There might be more than one frame annotated as present for each message.

Task 1: Diagnostic frame

Is this message identifying a social, political or labor issue relevant in the context of the union organization or the labor movement in general and/or assign blame for the issue?

Answer Yes or No.

- Posts should only be coded as part of this category if coders are able to articulate the problem that needs to be solved from the message alone. Specifically, posts could allude to “this” or “that” as problems. Such references do not count for problem identification.
- Issues should be considered as negative conditions (e.g. “*unfair wages*”) or more generally situations that could be improved (e.g. “*better work-life balance*”). They should, in general, be related to something relevant for the labor unions. For instance, talking about “*abortion*” without defining its labor movement relevance does not count as identifying an issue.
- Issues can be **generic** (e.g. “*bad working conditions*”) or **more specific** for given situations/set of stakeholders (e.g. “*catering workers can’t afford to live in SF anymore*”) but need to be clearly identified from the message alone for the message to be annotated as “Yes”.
- Issues should be collective (i.e. a problem for a set of workers) or, if individual, it should be clear how they are symptoms of a broader problem.
- Mentions of **workers rights** without any additional content (e.g. what the issue with workers rights is) do not clearly convey what the problem is that needs to be solved and would be coded as “No”.

e.g. “*We should all stand up for workers rights*” would be coded as “No” as there is no additional indication of what the problem with workers rights is.

e.g. *“Big companies such as X are limiting the expression of workers rights and we should all do something about it.”* would be coded as “Yes” since the issue is the limitation of the rights.

- The fact that a **collective agreement contract is missing** should not be considered an issue by itself but if details about the reason for the collective agreement to be established are given then the message could be considered as identifying an issue.
- Issues could be **described both in a positive and negative way**, e.g. *“improve working conditions”*, *“equal rights on healthcare”* and *“bad working conditions”* are all considered as issues relevant for the diagnostic frame.
- Personal stories about specific instances that are symptoms of broader union or labor movement problems (i.e. episodic frames) are marked “Yes”.

e.g. *“Last week, I spoke with Jane, a worker at a local manufacturing plant, who shared her struggles with unsafe working conditions. Despite multiple complaints, management has done nothing to fix the issues.”* would be coded as “Yes”.

- Content blaming any of the following entities for the cause of a labor union-related problem, as well as holding them responsible for the continuation of the problem: government, corporation, religion, larger social, political, and economic systems (e.g. society, the world, the country, capitalism, socialism), people or groups of people perceived to have power over the situation (e.g. social justice warriors, celebrities and public figures, immigrants), other institutions (e.g. schools, hospitals, police departments, individual police officers).

e.g. *“This is what we mean when we say the staffing crisis isnt new, for decades nurses have been describing the dangers of a system where profits come before patients.”* would be coded as “Yes”.

- If a person, group or institution is simply mentioned and implicitly criticized without being blamed for a problem related to labor unions and/or the labor movement, the message would be coded as “No”.

e.g. *“I sat next to an Amazon director on my flight yesterday. He sat in the wrong seat and would not move, prompts to him for staying on brand while traveling”* would be coded as “No” since it criticized an individual that represents Amazon as an employer but it does not explicitly blame Amazon for a labor movement issue.

- Issues that are referred to in the celebration of successful outcomes in the past can still qualify as issues relevant to the unions/labor movement

e.g. *“Ten years ago, we were fighting together and winning an historical contract for the improvement of working conditions of over 10k workers”* would be coded as “Yes”, since *“improvement of working conditions”* is a positive description of a labor movement issue that is relevant to present times as well (working conditions not being good enough).

- If a message mentions a protest or rally, it should be coded as “Yes” if the name of the demonstration **explicitly** conveys the problem.

e.g. “*Proud to take part in the #UnitedForFairWages march yesterday in Washington DC*” would be coded as “Yes” since the name of the march identifies “fair wages” as an issue and such issue is relevant for the labor movement.

- If a message discusses the reasons behind an action that is being taken, or the goal behind an action, and **such a reason/goal can be identified as an issue relevant to the union or the labor movement more in general**, it would be coded as “Yes”.

e.g. “*We are striking for safety on the workplace.*” would be coded as “Yes” since the reason for striking constitutes indeed an issue to be solved.

e.g. “*We are striking for workers rights*” would be coded as “No” because the issue is not clear, while “*We are striking for the respect of workers rights*” would be coded as “Yes” since a condition of workers rights not being respected can be identified as the issue.

Task 2: Prognostic frame

Is this message proposing solutions for a social or political issue relevant in the context of the labor movement, discussing strategies or tactics for achieving unions’ goals, or explicitly challenging arguments made by the opposing side? Answer Yes or No.

- Includes proposal of changes in laws and policies, changes in leaders (electing new officials or getting rid of existing leaders), or cultural/societal/norm changes that would address a problem.
- Proposed solutions can be generic (e.g. “*We need to **fight** to ensure equal rights*”) or specific (“*We need to contact the board, schedule a meeting and discuss together the options for a collective contract.*”). Note that **fighting** for, although generic, is still counting as part of the prognostic frame as it points towards a desired outcome and implies actions being taken to achieve it.
- If there is clearly a mention of an action being taken but the reason for which the action takes place cannot be clearly identified, the message should be coded as “No” as it would not indicate how the action will address a problem or issue.

e.g. “*We are issuing a statement in response to the court decision*” would be coded as “No”. While the action itself could be potentially a solution in the right context, it is not possible to identify the labor movement/union problem to be addressed from the message alone.

e.g. *"We are organizing a strike next monday to protect workers rights."* would be coded as "Yes" as there is a clear action being taken to advocate for an issue, which is workers rights being in danger.

- Solutions and tactics that refer to successful outcomes in the past do not qualify as they do not count as solutions proposals. **Prognostic frames describes solutions or tactics for addressing present or future problems.**

e.g. *"Ten years ago, we were striking together and winning an historical contract for the improvement of working conditions of over 10k workers"* would be coded as "No".

- Mentions of existing laws and policies (e.g. The Constitution, 2A/2nd Amendment, existing detention policies) should *not* be coded as "proposed solutions". However, a proposed solution might involve changes for protecting or reinforcing existing laws.

e.g. *"Our union is advocating for a new bill that would strengthen the protections in the Fair Labor Standards Act, ensuring that workers' overtime pay rights are better enforced and expanding protections for part-time workers."* would be coded as "Yes" since it proposes a change to an existing law.

e.g. *"The Constitution grants all citizens the right to free speech, but this has been challenged by recent court rulings."* would be coded as "No" as it a simple mention of the law in the context of a relevant issue does not constitute a proposed solution.

- Hashtags such as #FightForFairWages would be considered solutions, as doing such an action could solve the issue of low wages for employees. However, if the message contains hashtags such as #ReunificationNOW without a clear identification of the issue of reference for which the solution could be adopted, it should be marked as "No".
- Strategies and tactics include (but are not limited to): protests / demonstrations / rallies, boycotts, petitions, legal battles and lawsuits, campaigning, voting in elections, contacting political leaders (e.g. Senators), education about the movement or underlying issues (e.g. education on the protection of workers rights).
- Being part of a union, joining a union or similar activities can be considered as solutions when they are proposed as a way to overcome some issues that are relevant to the labor movement.

e.g. *"With the aid of a union, no one needs to worry about unfair wages."*

- Explicitly challenging arguments (not actions) made by the opposing side (generally employers) with messages that present and refute an argument from the opposing side is considered as a prognostic frame. The message may challenge the opposing side's argument by simply stating that they are incorrect, presenting counterevidence, ridiculing the opposing arguments or its proponents or drawing analogies that make clear that the opposing argument is flawed.

e.g. “@Macy’s cannot complain of laziness when their CEO is on vacation for half a year” would be coded as “Yes”.

- Messages should be coded as “Yes” even if the solution is not tangible (e.g. “stand up for”, “support”).

e.g. “This Friday, we’re hosting a rally at the city hall to demand that our representatives support fair wages for teachers.” would be coded as “Yes” since it proposes a rally as a solution to advocate for workers’ rights.

e.g. “Our union is facing tough times, but we remain committed to standing up for workers’ rights in every workplace.” would be coded as “Yes” as it proposes being committed to support workers’ rights as a solution, even if subtly.

e.g. “We are proud to support Kansas City members for a better contract” would be coded as “Yes” since supporting members is proposed as a solution.

- Some strategies might include an action to be taken to mitigate the underlying issues and might be expressed in a “call-to-action” fashion.

e.g. “[...] If you want to improve your working conditions, join the Teamsters today!” would be coded as “Yes” since joining the organization is proposed as a solution to improve working conditions. [Note that this message is also *diagnostic* (“improve your working conditions”) and *motivational* (“call to action to join the movement”)].

Task 3: Motivational frame

Does the message encourage followers to take action (either individually or collectively) in support of a union or of causes relevant to the labor movements, such as joining, participating, or doing something specific?

- This includes explicit calls to action to join the organization, participate in events or initiatives organized by the union or performing actions that could be beneficial for the union and/or its goals.

e.g. “Join us this Saturday for our rally to support fair wages for all workers! Stand with us and make your voice heard.” would be coded as “Yes” as it is a request of a take a collective action to support the unions’ cause.

e.g. “Write to your representative and tell them that unfair wages should stop!” would be coded as “Yes” as it is an example of a call for an individual action that could be beneficial for the unions’ cause.

e.g. *"It's time for [Employer Name] to prioritize fair wages and safe working conditions for all employees."* would be coded as "Yes" as it is requesting the employer to perform an action that could improve the condition of workers and thus support the unions' goals.

- Implicit call-to-action messages should be coded as "No", as the message alone is not enough to clarify the function of the message.

e.g. *"The deadline to register is tomorrow!"* despite the sense of urgency conveyed by the message and the presence of an implicit call to action for registering, the message would be coded as "No" because, if taken in isolation, it does not convey a motivational frame.

- Call-to-action expressions that refer to **promotional content do not count** (see Task 5).

e.g. *"As a union member, you can get 50% off cinema tickets! Claim your discount today."*

- Call-to-action messages that refer to political or social issues that are of interest to the labor union would be coded as "Yes".

e.g. *"Voting for candidates that respect union rights is crucial. Send your support letter today!"* would be coded as "Yes".

- If motivational messages are part of a reported speech and the speech is not challenged by the union organization (e.g. it is not the speech of opponents but that of union representatives), the message would be coded as containing a motivational frame.
- Motivational messages often (but not necessarily) imply a sense of severity, urgency, stress how effective the movement will be at achieving its goals and how much of an impact the reader's participation will have, focusing on the reader's moral obligation or duty to participate.
- Action could be very tangible or less concrete, for instance care about, talk about, stand up for, pay attention to.

e.g. *"Workers deserve a voice in their workplace decisions. Let's make sure we're paying attention to how our colleagues are treated and speak out when we see injustice."* would be coded as "Yes".

- General attention-related messages, e.g. *"Stay tuned!"* would be coded as "No".
- Messages that prompt to learn/read more about something without having a clear benefit for the organizations should be coded as "No".

e.g. *"Learn more about Josh and its story at [...]"* would be coded as "No".

- Calls to social media actions can count if it is clear how they would be beneficial for the union's cause.

e.g. *"Help us spread the word and use the hashtag #UnitedIsBetter to show support for the union family in these dark times."* would be coded as "Yes" since the action of using the hashtags is clearly targeted as benefiting the union by spreading its values.

e.g. *"Drop a comment if you are coming"* would be coded as "No" since the action of commenting the post will not benefit the union or its goals but it is simply a prompt for interaction (see Task 5).

Task 4: Community frame

Does this message emphasize shared identity, unity, or the collective strength of the union? Answer Yes or No.

- Messages that emphasize **shared identity, unity, group strength, "family" bonds** of the union organization for common goals or against oppressors.

e.g. *"They will never forget our name as long as we are united. #UnionStrong #unionsforall"* would be coded as "Yes" since it stresses the importance of unions' unity.

e.g. *"Unions are your friends #TogetherWeFightTogetherWeWin"* would be coded as "Yes".

- Unity or partnership of the union with other organizations/institutions does not count as conveying unity.

- Content containing **commemoration of victories, prizes, strikes, successful negotiation processes** would be coded as "Yes" since they are part of a narrative which emphasizes the union strength, cohesion and celebration of the labor movement. Note that simple report of facts do not count as part of this category.

e.g. *"Healthcare workers fighting back and winning big! The pics show moments after our historic tentative agreement for 85,000 Kaiser Permanente healthcare workers across the country! #coalitionstrong"* would be coded as "Yes".

e.g. *"We issued a statement in response to the board decision"* is simply a fact and does not refer to the action as a success to commemorate. It would be coded as "No".

- It should be clear that the commemoration refers to an event related to the union itself, and not to other organizations or unions or individuals for which a union bond is not explicit.

- **Commemoration of events or anniversaries that are meaningful to the unions** and to the labor movement more in general are coded as "Yes".

e.g. “30 years ago, our founder started a project that allowed us to be here together today, standing up for workers rights” would be coded as “Yes”.

- Messages **giving thanks and recognition** to volunteers, sponsors, and other relevant stakeholders for their role in the unions’ success would be coded as “Yes” since they emphasize a sense of unity and collective identity.

e.g. “Had a great turnout for our 2023 Health Fair. Thank you to over 200 LiUNA! 177 members and family members who attended.” would be coded as “Yes”.

- Messages **containing members stories, that are usually aimed at inspiring others**, would be coded as “Yes”

e.g. “Follow Union Member Tony as he discovers just why unions have been important, are important, and will be important. Please enjoy Friday Funnies Presents: The Ghosts Of Unions #UFCW1500 #FYP #union” would be coded as “Yes” since the aim is to inspire others.

- Since it is hard to distinguish to when messages are actually fostering collective identity by creating a sense of bond over hurdles or simply stressing a problem/issue in a very strong way (as most of the messages posted by labor unions do), messages that are related to the collective impact of issues only count as diagnostic (Task 1).

e.g. “Hundreds of workers are left alone without any certainty about their rights” would be coded as “No” as it mainly stresses the issue as a collective problem but it does not count as emphasizing unity and strength.

- Empowerment and support of workers for a given goal is seen more as a solution (Task 2) than as a community-building element.

e.g. “We want to empower our members through educational programs to know more about their rights and how to protect them” would be coded as “No”.

Task 5: Engagement frame

Is the message aiming at other types of audience engagement? Answer Yes or No.

- Content that shares tips or advice, without the aim of inspiring others or getting followers to do something for the organization.

e.g. “For today’s ‘the voice of a member’ we have Tom telling us why we should check our batteries at home.” would be coded as “Yes”: while it involves a union member, the aim is not to inspire others but simply to give information to the community.

- Messages that acknowledge noteworthy events, such as holiday greetings and support of community events or sports teams. Note that such events do not include

commemoration of unions' anniversaries or of important dates for the labor movement (see Task 4).

e.g. *"Happy Christmas From Teamsters Local 542 #Teamsters542 #Teamsters"*

- Messages to promote the publishing of a new story/content.

e.g. *"Today is the 10th episode of 'A day in the union'"*

- Messages that act as reminders of deadlines, since such reminders act as implicit call-to-action that cannot be classified as motivational frames. Also messages sharing content about possible actions to be taken without an explicit call-to-action would be considered part of this category.

e.g. *"The deadline to register to the conference is next week".*

e.g. *"Here is your weekly strikes schedule for SF"*

- Content that prompt the followers/audience for an interaction on the social media, commenting, reacting or sharing thoughts or stories.

e.g. *"As a member of the union, how do YOU make your rights matter?"*

e.g. *"Comment below if you have a similar experience!"*

- Promotional messages, sponsoring products or services.

e.g. *"As a union member, you can get 50% off cinema tickets!"*

- Note that there are some cases in which there are some products or services sponsored that are offered as a solution to a labor union relevant issue (i.e. see also Tasks 1 and 2).

e.g. *"Safety on the job should be a priority for you. Consider signing up to our personal insurance program."* would be annotated as "Yes", and would be also considered an example of diagnostic, prognostic and motivational frames.

Bonus Task: Political Endorsement

Is the message showing political endorsement for certain candidates or external institutions? Answer Yes or No.

In the special context of labor unions and their online communication, there are cases in which the organization manifests support for politicians or other external groups.

e.g. *“In the 2024 presidential elections, we chose to support Kamala Harris”* would be coded as “Yes”.

e.g. *“In this electoral marathon, it is people like Kamala Harris that show how much unions matter and will matter for the rights of every worker in America.”* would be coded as “Yes”.